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# National report submitted pursuant to Human Rights Council resolutions 5/1 and 16/21*

# Suriname

* The present document is being issued without formal editing.



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# I. Introduction

1. The Republic of Suriname hereby presents its fourth national report within the framework of the UPR of the Human Rights Council of the United Nations. This report covers the period 2021–2026 and provides an overview of measures, legislative developments, policy initiatives, institutional strengthening and challenges relating to the implementation of human rights obligations and previous UPR recommendations.

2. The Constitution of the Republic of Suriname (S.B. 1987 no. 116, as amended) forms the basis of the national legal order and safeguards the principle of non-discrimination (art. 8(2)), gender equality (art. 35), the right to health (art. 36), the protection of youth (art. 37) and the right to education (art. 39). Pursuant to articles 105 and 106, approved treaty provisions have direct effect and take precedence over national legislation, provided that by their content they can be binding on everyone.

3. Suriname proactively operationalizes its international human rights obligations under the core treaties to which the State is a party (ICCPR, ICESCR, CRC, CEDAW, CRPD, ICERD and CAT). This synergy directly implements the UN 2030 Agenda, with specific focus on poverty reduction (SDG 1), food security (SDG 2), universal health care (SDG 3), quality education (SDG 4), gender equality (SDG 5), decent work (SDG 8), reducing inequality (SDG 10), sustainable communities (SDG 11), climate action (SDG 13) and strong rule-of-law institutions (SDG 16).

4. In order to give material effect to the principle of ‘leaving no one behind’, Suriname applies a rights-based approach within its national planning. Legislative and policy priorities are de facto geared towards the legal protection and structural inclusion of historically and socially vulnerable groups, in particular women, children, older persons, persons with disabilities, and Indigenous and tribal peoples. This approach guides the specific measures and programs presented in this report.

# II. Methodology and consultation process

5. This report was prepared under the coordination of the State of Suriname through a participatory and inter-institutional approach. Data collection and substantive validation took place through broad consultations with the National Assembly, line ministries, academic institutions and independent experts. Civil society, including NGOs, women’s, youth and older-persons’ organizations, as well as representatives of persons with disabilities and Indigenous and tribal peoples, was actively consulted (see Annex 2 for the list of stakeholders).

6. Quantitative substantiation and policy information were systematically drawn from the SPS and the ABS. In addition, the State cooperated strategically with international partners, including OHCHR, UNDP, UNICEF, UNFPA, IOM and PAHO, in support of capacity-strengthening and data validation. This results in a balanced document that reflects both de jure progress and de facto structural challenges.

# III. Measures and programs for the implementation of the UPR recommendations

7. The legislative, institutional and policy measures taken to implement the accepted UPR recommendations are grouped thematically. Implementation takes place in accordance with the relevant international human rights treaties and national legislation, supported by the SDGs where applicable. For the detailed implementation matrix, reference is made to Annex 3.

(a) Institutional human rights framework and rule of law: (Recommendations 97.1–97.20, 97.101, 97.103, 97.105, 99.12, 99.13). Implementation takes place in accordance with the ICCPR and ICESCR. On 16 November 2021, Suriname acceded to the Convention against Torture. Suriname continues to consider possible accession to the Second Optional Protocol to the ICCPR (ICCPR-OP2). In addition, the State is considering accession to

OPCAT, OP-CEDAW, OP-CRPD and OP-ICESCR. The relevant national assessments, consultations and preparatory processes are ongoing. The rule-of-law framework is anchored in the Constitution (S.B. 1987 no. 116, last amended S.B. 2023 no. 157), the Constitutional Court Act (S.B. 2019 no. 118), the Rules of Procedure of the National Assembly (S.B. 1990 no. 43), the Police Charter 1971 (G.B. 1971 no. 70) and the amendment of the Military Criminal Code (S.B. 2021 no. 117), by which the death penalty was abolished. The draft National Human Rights Institute Act is in the final pre-parliamentary consultation phase, with an intended completion date of end November 2026. Although freedom of expression and freedom of the press are constitutionally guaranteed, the State takes note of Suriname's decline on the World Press Freedom Index, from position 28 in 2024 to 34 in 2026. The State recognizes the importance of further review and revision of relevant criminal-law provisions that may restrict the exercise of freedom of expression, in light of article 19 ICCPR. In this context, the further treatment of the draft Freedom of Information Act constitutes an important step towards strengthening transparency and access to government information.

(b) Non-discrimination, inclusion and gender equality: (Recommendations 97.21, 97.22, 97.23, 97.61, 97.64, 97.73, 97.83, 97.97, 97.102, 97.104, 97.106, 98.35). In accordance with CEDAW, ICERD and the ICCPR, the Equal Treatment in Employment Act (S.B. 2022 no. 137), the Act on Violence and Sexual Harassment in Employment (S.B. 2022 no. 136) and the Domestic Violence Act (S.B. 2009 no. 84) provide protection against gender discrimination and violence. Maternity leave and family protection are anchored in mandatory law in the Family Labour Protection Act (S.B. 2019 no. 64). The NBG and the NRHG strengthen implementation.

(c) Slavery, forced labour and human trafficking: (Recommendations 97.22, 97.35, 97.36, 97.37 and 97.38). Implementation takes place in accordance with the ICCPR, ICESCR, UNTOC, the Palermo Protocol and ILO Conventions 29 and 105. The criminal-law framework is anchored in the Criminal Code (G.B. 1911 no. 1, as amended S.B. 2023 no. 135). The national implementation and enforcement framework is strengthened by the specialized TIP unit within the KPS. The financial and preventive framework is strengthened by the Anti-Money Laundering and Terrorist Financing Act (Wwft, S.B. 2023 no. 133) and the OWVV (draft act).

(d) Children's rights and child protection: (Recommendations 97.35, 97.79, 97.82, 97.84, 97.80, 97.81, 97.91, 97.93, 97.95, 97.96). Implementation of this theme takes place in accordance with the CRC, including the OP-CRC-AC and OP_CRC-SC, as well as the ICCPR and ICESCR. In civil-law terms the national legal framework is shaped to a significant extent by the Civil Code (Book 1 – Law of Persons and Family Law). The criminal-law protection of minors is anchored in the Criminal Code (G.B. 1911 no. 1, as last amended by S.B. 2023 no. 135). Criminal-procedural safeguards are governed by the Code of Criminal Procedure (G.B. 1977 no. 94, as last amended). In addition, the institutional protection of children's rights is strengthened by the Children's Ombudsperson Act (S.B. 2025 no. 1), which provides for the establishment of the Children's Ombudsman Institute Suriname. The protection and guidance of minors within the juvenile-justice framework is further safeguarded by the Youth Protection (Organization) Act (G.B. 1965 no. 110), as well as by the Decree on the Implementation of Educational and Work Projects and Community Service for Juveniles (S.B. 2025 no. 2).

(e) Social protection, labour, education and economic rights: (Recommendations 97.22, 97.39, 97.40, 97.41, 97.42, 97.43, 97.87, 97.88, 97.89, 97.90, 97.91, 97.92, 97.93, 97.106). Labour rights are implemented in accordance with the ICESCR, CRC and fundamental ILO conventions (nos. 100, 102, 111). The revised Labour Act 1963 (S.B. 2023 no. 125) and the Employment of Children and Young Persons Act (S.B. 2018 no. 76) safeguard the elimination of child labour. Trade-union rights are anchored through the Freedom of Trade Union Association Act (S.B. 2016 no. 151). Protection against discrimination, abuse and unlawful dismissal is anchored in mandatory law in the Dismissal Act 2018 (S.B. 2018 no. 94), the Equal Treatment in Employment Act (S.B. 2022 no. 137) and the Act on Violence and Sexual Harassment in Employment (S.B. 2022 no. 136). Social and income security are safeguarded by the Minimum Wage Act (S.B. 2024 no. 31), the General Pension Act (S.B. 2014 no. 113), the Pension Funds Act (S.B. 2005 no. 75) and the New Civil Code (S.B. 2024 no. 164). ILO Conventions C155, C187 and C190 have been

approved by Parliament; ratification is a priority. The draft Occupational Health and Safety Act is also under consideration. To mitigate the decline in purchasing power among low-income groups, the State is implementing targeted social safety nets. In addition, through the Maternal and Perinatal Death Surveillance and Response (MPDSR) model, the State is actively working to reduce maternal and child mortality, linked to policy programs to safeguard equal access to quality primary education. The necessary legislation, including the draft Financial Inclusion Act and the draft Electronic Communications Act, is currently in the final stage of treatment before the National Assembly.

(f) Right to health and mental health care: (Recommendations 97.21, 97.22, 97.23, 97.61, 97.73, 97.83, 97.97, 97.102, 97.104, 97.106, 98.35, 99.8, 99.9, 99.10 and 99.11). The health-law framework of the Republic of Suriname is implemented in accordance with the ICESCR, the CRC and the CRPD, in line with SDG 3. This framework is anchored in the National Basic Health Insurance Act (S.B. 2014 no. 114, as last amended in 2023), which regulates access to basic health care and the health-financing system. Patients' rights derive from the Constitution, civil law, criminal law and professional medical standards. These include the right to information, informed consent to treatment, confidentiality and the possibility of lodging a complaint. The institutional framework will be further strengthened by the draft Public Health Framework Act, which aims to modernize and integrate the public-health system.

(g) Conditions of detention and administration of justice: (Recommendations 97.55, 97.56, 97.57, 97.58, 97.59, 97.60). The legal framework concerning conditions of detention and the administration of justice in the Republic of Suriname is based on the Criminal Code (1911, as revised in 2009, 2020 and 2023) and the Code of Criminal Procedure (1977), which regulate criminalization, prosecution and the conduct of criminal proceedings. The execution of custodial sentences and measures is regulated in the Penitentiary Institutions and Remand Center's Act (S.B. 2020 no. 27) and the Penitentiary Decree, which together set out the organization, treatment and legal status of detainees in penitentiary institutions. For juveniles, the execution of sanctions is additionally regulated by the Youth Protection (Organization) Act (G.B. 1965 no. 110) and the Decree on the Implementation of Educational and Work Projects and Community Service for Juveniles (S.B. 2025 no. 2), which provide for alternative sanctions and resocialization. This framework is implemented in accordance with the ICCPR and CAT, and is in line with the Nelson Mandela Rules on the minimum standards for the treatment of prisoners.

(h) Persons with disabilities: (Recommendations 97.61, 97.73, 97.86, 97.87, 97.88, 97.102, 97.106). Suriname implements its policy for persons with disabilities in accordance with the CRPD. The draft General Act for Persons with Disabilities (AWMB) is currently before Parliament for harmonization.

(i) Rights of Indigenous and tribal peoples: (Recommendations 97.24, 97.36, 97.61–97.63, 97.65–97.78, 97.85, 97.86, 97.87, 97.94, 98.1–98.21, 98.23–98.24). The State maintains its support for UNDRIP and recognizes the remaining constitutional challenges in the full de jure implementation of the standing judgments of the Inter-American Court of Human Rights, namely Moiwana (2005), Saramaka (2007), and Kali'ña and Lokono (2015). The draft Act on the Collective Rights of Indigenous and Tribal Peoples is before Parliament. In May 2026, the Land Rights Project 2026–2030 was launched with UNDP. This project facilitates renewed consultations on the basis of the FPIC principle towards the legal-technical finalization of the draft Financial Inclusion Act and the draft Electronic Communications Act, which are also under consideration and which are necessary for the de facto elimination of digital and financial exclusion in the interior.

(j) Climate, environment and sustainable development: (Recommendations 97.21, 97.22, 97.24, 98.28–98.29). The environmental-law framework of the Republic of Suriname is anchored in mandatory law in the Environmental Framework Act (S.B. 2020 no. 97, as last amended by S.B. 2024 no. 56). For the de jure and de facto enforcement of this legislation, the State has made the National Environmental Authority (NMA), an autonomous administrative body with legal personality, operational. Implementation of this centralized environmental policy takes place in strict accordance with the obligations under the Paris Agreement and the Minamata Convention, towards the realization of the objectives within SDG 13 and SDG 15.

8. The further operational elaboration and sectoral results are addressed in the thematic chapters of this report.

# IV. International treaty system and cooperation with human rights mechanisms

9. The Republic of Suriname upholds its obligations as a State party to the core UN human rights treaties, including the ICCPR, ICESCR, ICERD, CEDAW, CRC, CRPD and CAT/UNCAT, including the optional protocols OP-ICCPR, OP2-ICCPR, OP-CRC-AC and OP-CRC-SC. Ratification of OPCAT, OP-CEDAW and OP-CRPD is currently in the pre-parliamentary preparatory phase.

10. Interdepartmental implementation, monitoring and reporting take place under the central direction of the Human Rights Bureau of the Ministry of Justice and Police (JusPol). This inter-ministerial coordination is structurally anchored through permanent institutional focal points within the respective line ministries and NGOs.

11. To strengthen evidence-based policymaking and the monitoring of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the State works closely with the ABS and the Suriname Planning Bureau Foundation (SPS) through the National SDG Committee and the National Recommendations Tracking Database (NRTD). This process is de facto flanked by structural stakeholder engagement with civil society, including the WRC, VIDS, NVB, VSG, ASA, ISOS and the LGBTQ+ Platform Suriname, as well as through strategic international assistance from OHCHR, UNDP, UNICEF, UNFPA, IOM, PAHO/WHO, UN Women and the ILO.

# V. Human rights education, capacity-building and awareness-raising

12. This section reflects the implementation of SDGs 4, 5, 10, 16 and 17, in conjunction with UPR recommendations 97.42, 97.61, 97.86, 97.87, 97.88, 97.102, 97.106 and 98.35.

13. In implementation of the ICCPR, CAT, CEDAW, CRC and national legislation, including the Criminal Code (S.B. 2015 no. 44), the Domestic Violence Act (S.B. 2009 no. 85) and the Act on Violence and Sexual Harassment in Employment (S.B. 2022 no. 136), structural training is provided within the KPS, the Public Prosecution Service and JusPol on human rights, victim-center law enforcement, gender-based violence, human trafficking and child protection. This training aims to strengthen the human-rights-compliant exercise of police and prosecutorial powers. The Police Charter 1971 (G.B. 1971 no. 70) provides the legal basis for the organization and tasks of the KPS. Draft legislation is also in preparation to strengthen victim protection, investigative powers and human-rights-compliant interrogation practices.

14. In implementation of the Palermo Protocol, CEDAW, the CRC and the Criminal Code (S.B. 2015 no. 44), the specialized TIP unit of the KPS carries out targeted capacity programs in cooperation with the Aliens Service and Regional Assistance on victim identification and protection. At the same time, the legal framework on human trafficking and migrant smuggling is continuously updated to strengthen prevention, prosecution and international legal assistance.

15. In cooperation with UN agencies, training has been carried out since 2024 on PSEA, integrity standards and victim protection. These contribute to the implementation of CEDAW and CAT. In 2024, the Convention against Torture Initiative supported technical training on human-rights-compliant investigative interviewing. Further institutionalization of PSEA standards within national regulations is under development.

16. Since 2022, the National Army has provided Public Order Maintenance (HOO) training in support of civilian authorities, in compliance with international human rights standards.

17. To effectively promote CEDAW, the Convention of Belém do Pará and the CRPD, the BGA directs structural capacity trajectories and referral workshops to promote gender equality, non-discrimination and inclusion. These inter-institutional interventions, carried out in cooperation with judicial actors, UN organizations and civil society within the Gender Vision Policy Document 2021–2035, target first responders, public officials and community leaders. The training operationalizes the national referral pathway for victims, victim-centred service delivery, gender mainstreaming and inclusive decision-making, to strengthen legal protection against domestic and gender-based violence.

18. To promote the CRPD, the CRC, the ICESCR and the OP-CRC-AC, the State implements targeted sectoral policy programs. Within the welfare domain, the National Policy Plan for Persons with Disabilities 2025–2030 was adopted in April 2025, developed by the Presidential Working Group in cooperation with UNICEF, to operationalize inclusion, accessibility and equal opportunities. In 2025, the National Multisectoral Early Childhood Development Policy 2025–2035 was also ratified to strengthen intersectoral care. Within the education domain, since 2024, in the framework of the National Education Policy Plan Suriname 2024–2031 (NOBS) and the Education Innovation Programme (OVP), the MinOWC has implemented structural training for education professionals on human rights education, Basic Life Skills and inclusive pedagogy. This capacity-building is flanked by strategic partnerships with UNICEF (2023–2025) and the Judiciary; this includes specialized training programs on the early detection and reporting of child abuse, as well as district-level interventions since 2025 against grooming, online sexual exploitation and child pornography within the school system.

19. The University Institute for Children's Rights (UK) of the AdeKUS has, since 2023, supported research, training and awareness-raising on children's rights and child protection, strengthening the national implementation of the CRC.

20. In the period 2023–2025, the IGSR (AdeKUS), in cooperation with UNICEF, provided specialized training for professionals in child protection and social work. In addition, the Faculty of Legal Sciences and the AWJ carried out training programs for confidential counsellors to implement the Act on Violence and Sexual Harassment in Employment (S.B. 2022 no. 136). In 2025, the Post-Master Program in Legislation was accredited and deployed to strengthen national capacity in legislative drafting.

21. Since 2024, the AWJ has implemented structural youth programs focused on participation, mental health, violence prevention and life skills, in line with the CRC.

22. The NJI, established pursuant to S.B. 2023 no. 74, has since 2023 supported youth development, participation and policy coordination. This has led to strengthened involvement of young people in policy dialogues and community programs.

23. Since 2024, the Single Mother Project Suriname Foundation (SSMPS) has carried out awareness-raising and empowerment activities focused on menstrual health, gender equality and the socio-economic participation of women and girls from vulnerable groups, which has contributed to strengthened social inclusion.

24. In 2026, the Ministry of ROS and UNDP carried out consultation and capacity trajectories in the interior aimed at raising awareness of collective rights and the participation of Indigenous and tribal peoples.

# VI. Equality and non-discrimination

25. This section concerns the implementation of SDGs 3, 5, 8, 10 and 16 and UPR recommendations 97.23, 97.61, 97.22, 97.73, 97.87, 97.88, 97.102, 97.106, 98.43 and 98.48 on non-discrimination and inclusion. The constitutional framework (art. 8(2) and art. 35) forms the basis for equal treatment and protection against discrimination, in line with international obligations under the ICCPR, CEDAW and CRPD.

26. Suriname has strengthened the legal framework on non-discrimination in the labour market through the Equal Treatment in Employment Act (S.B. 2022 no. 137) and the Act on Violence and Sexual Harassment in Employment (S.B. 2022 no. 136). The ILO Decent Work

Country Program (DWCP) 2023–2026 supports its implementation. In 2024–2025, capacity-strengthening activities were carried out for the Labour Inspectorate and social partners aimed at supervision, awareness-raising and the promotion of equal treatment in the workplace.

27. To promote gender equality and combat gender-based violence, the Gender Vision Policy Document 2021–2035 and the SRHR Policy 2020–2030 are being implemented, including within the framework of the Convention of Belém do Pará. The Suriname LGBTQ+ Needs Assessment Report (2023) contributed to identifying priorities on inclusion and non-discrimination. The 2025 visit of the UN Working Group of Experts on People of African Descent produced recommendations to strengthen inclusion and combat structural discrimination.

28. Within the framework of the CRPD, the National Policy Document on Persons with Disabilities 2025–2030 was adopted to promote inclusion, accessibility and the equal participation of persons with disabilities.

29. To improve access to health care in the interior, in the period 2024–2026, within the SIP Plus program (Sipaliwini Partnerships), mobile health interventions were carried out by the Regional Health Service and the Medical Mission for vulnerable groups in remote areas.

30. Within the Education Innovation Program 2021–2025, measures were taken to promote inclusive education, including accessibility measures and adapted teaching materials for pupils with specific educational needs, which contributed to improved access to education and a reduction in early school-leaving among children with disabilities.

31. To strengthen labour rights and safe and healthy working conditions, Suriname has taken further steps with respect to ILO Conventions no. 155 on occupational safety and health, no. 187 on the promotional framework for occupational safety and health, and no. 190 on violence and harassment in the world of work. These conventions have been tacitly approved by the National Assembly and are in the further national approval and ratification process. In addition, ILO Recommendations Nos. 204, 205 and 206 are being considered in the further development of policy on decent work, inclusion and the transition from informal to formal labour. The draft Occupational Health and Safety Act is currently before the National Assembly, with the Committee of Rapporteurs conducting consultations with relevant stakeholders.

# VII. Extrajudicial executions, the rule of law and public safety

32. This part implements SDG 16, in conjunction with UPR recommendations 97.31–97.33, 97.42, 97.61, 97.102 and 97.106 concerning effective legal protection, the right to life and the independence of the judiciary.

33. Suriname reaffirms its obligations under articles 2 and 6 of the ICCPR and relevant inter-American human rights instruments. In the case Moiwana Community v. Suriname, individual and structural remedial measures have been implemented, including a State apology (2006) and a commemorative monument (2007). The implementation of further collective remedial measures and the strengthening of the legal position of Indigenous and tribal peoples is ongoing. The draft Act on the Collective Rights of Indigenous and Tribal Peoples (2020) is currently before the National Assembly.

34. In the criminal case concerning the December Murders, the Court of Justice confirmed the convictions on 20 December 2023. The execution of the criminal decisions was carried out in 2024 within the national criminal-justice system by the Judiciary and the KPA, in accordance with statutory procedures.

35. Access to justice is safeguarded through a decentralized chain of police and the Judiciary. In the interior, this is supplemented by mobile interventions and field missions, giving even remote communities access to legal protection and legal referral.

36. The capacity of the KPS was strengthened in 2025–2026 with digital and technological means, including drones and camera technology, to support investigation, evidence-gathering and public-order maintenance in urban and rural areas.

37. The capacity of the national security sector has been strengthened through strategic and regional partnerships. In 2022, the National Army carried out targeted training on Public Order Maintenance. In the period 2024–2026, operational capacity against cross-border crime and human trafficking was further increased through active participation in the regional CariSECURE 2.0 program of UNDP. Furthermore, in May 2026 Suriname hosted the 40th annual conference of the Association of Caribbean Commissioners of Police, which resulted in sharpened regional strategies for data-driven crime-fighting.

38. The State of Suriname maintains strict control over domestic police action, in accordance with the requirements of proportionality and subsidiarity as anchored in Article 12 of the Police Charter 1971. Through the Personnel Investigation Department, the KPS oversees strict compliance with these use-of-force instructions and, in cases of abuse, immediately initiates an independent investigation. Since 2025, the KPS has systematically moved to a community-oriented policing approach, in which police officers and neighborhood managers are continuously trained internally in client-orientation, conflict resolution and de-escalation techniques to structurally prevent disproportionate force in law enforcement.

39. To further modernize the rule of law and give effect to the right to trial within a reasonable time, the Judiciary of Suriname successfully implemented the digital Criminal Justice Registration and Information System (RISS) as of 23 July 2025. This transition to digitized proceedings minimizes administrative delays in the transfer of criminal files, optimizes procedural transparency and significantly accelerates the throughput time of criminal proceedings. This de facto contributes to preventing excessive and unlawful pre-trial detention. Furthermore, to combat impunity and strengthen the legal position of victims, the Judiciary structurally expanded the competences of the Service for the Execution of Criminal Sentences (DES) as of 19 February 2026. Whereas the DES previously focused primarily on traffic offences, the service is now tasked with the de facto execution of judicial rulings in a wide range of ordinary criminal cases. This includes actively tracing convicted persons and ensuring the actual payment of civil damages awarded to injured parties, which substantially intensifies national legal certainty and victim care.

40. In 2026, the National Assembly adopted the Act amending the Road Traffic Act 1971 (Rijwet) and the Suriname Fire Service Act 1993. These strengthen road safety, fire prevention and disaster management. They contribute to the protection of the right to life and physical integrity (arts. 6 and 9 ICCPR) and improve public safety. The amended Fire Service Act also strengthens occupational-safety standards for operational personnel in accordance with art. 7 ICESCR.

# VIII. Conditions of detention and juvenile justice

41. This section reflects the implementation of SDG 16 and UPR recommendations 97.42, 97.61, 97.102 and 97.106, in accordance with Suriname’s obligations under the ICCPR, in particular articles 6, 9 and 10, as well as the CRC, in particular articles 37 and 40.

42. The legal framework for the execution of custodial sentences and measures has been strengthened by the Penitentiary Institutions and Remand Centres Act (S.B. 2023 no. 147) and the Penitentiary Decree (S.B. 2023 no. 148). This legislation contributes to the further implementation of international standards on the humane treatment of persons deprived of their liberty, including the United Nations Standard Minimum Rules for the Treatment of Prisoners (Nelson Mandela Rules).

43. Detention policy focuses on resocialization, capacity management, and statutory standards, marked by launching officer training in 2023 and the Central Resocialization Department in 2025.

44. In 2026 the KPA expanded psychosocial capacity through the deployment of 18 certified case managers in support of the Forensic Social Care service. In line with this, in 2026 the State is working towards the operationalization of a forensic observation facility for the specialized reception and guidance of detainees with a psychological or intellectual disability. This institutional care is de jure flanked by targeted educational programs; thus, in

2025 the Adult Education Program for primary education was successfully completed, and since 2022 detainees are structurally afforded the legal space to successfully complete secondary or tertiary studies already commenced in the final phase of detention, to promote a seamless reintegration.

45. On 27 March 2026, a specialized hearing room was put into operation at the De Nieuwe Grond police station for the reception and questioning of victims of domestic and gender-based violence. This facility contributes to a victim-center approach within the criminal-justice chain and strengthens the protection of vulnerable groups.

46. Juveniles in conflict with the law are treated within a specialized juvenile-justice framework. The Juvenile Correction Centre, as an operational part of the Corps of Penitentiary Officers in accordance with article 1 of the Penitentiary Institutions and Remand Center Act (S.B. 2023 no. 147), provides reception, education, guidance and resocialization for juveniles.

47. The pre-trial detention, separate detention and treatment of juvenile suspects take place within the specialized Opa Doeli Juvenile Detention Centre, in accordance with the Youth Protection Organization Act (G.B. 1965 no. 110), the Criminal Code (S.B. 2009 no. 34) and the Code of Criminal Procedure. Specialized juvenile prosecutors and juvenile judges safeguard child-friendly justice and a strict separation between minor and adult detainees.

48. The current occupancy in 2026 in the Opa Doeli Juvenile Transit Centre (capacity: 72) and the Juvenile Correctional Institution / Juvenile Correction Centre (capacity: 33) fluctuates between 20 and 35 juveniles in pre-trial detention and detention, of whom the number of convictions ranges between 20 and 33 juveniles. The Police Social Service (Juvenile Affairs) is currently successfully executing alternative educational and community-service sanctions through the Assistant Officer Model.

49. The implementation of the National Strategic Action Plan for Juvenile Justice and Resocialization supports structural reforms within the juvenile-justice system, based on both criminal-law and civil-law frameworks. The policy is built around three pillars:

(a) Legislation and restorative justice: The introduction of the State Decree on the Implementation of Educational and Work Projects and Community Service for Juveniles (S.B. 2025 no. 2) has strengthened the legal framework for alternative sanctions and promotes the application of restorative-justice approaches.

(b) Policy programs and prevention: The Judiciary carries out preventive and alternative interventions, including programs aimed at early guidance of at-risk youth, reduction of recidivism and out-of-court settlement of less serious offences.

(c) Resocialization and education: Within the JCC, education, vocational-training and skills programs are offered, including technical and agricultural training, aimed at sustainable reintegration and social participation.

50. To give effect to the earlier recommendations on access to efficient justice, the State has substantially strengthened the capacity of the sitting judiciary. Whereas the Court of Justice of Suriname previously operated under heavy pressure with a stable roster of 31 judges, a historic capacity expansion has been achieved through the successful implementation of the three-year RAIO training programs (Judicial Officers in Training). The Judiciary will be expanded to 47 judges by the end of the 2026 court year. By the end of 2027, approximately 12 more new judges are expected. The intention is to continue the training programs for the Judiciary.

# IX. Slavery, forced labour and human trafficking

51. This section concerns the implementation of SDG 8 and SDG 16 and the UPR recommendations on the prevention and combating of human trafficking, forced labour and exploitation, in accordance with the ICCPR and the Palermo Protocol.

52. Human trafficking and sexual and labour exploitation are criminalized in articles 334a–334f of the Criminal Code (S.B. 2015 no. 44), in accordance with the Palermo Protocol.

This framework is supplemented by the Act on Violence and Sexual Harassment in Employment (S.B. 2022 no. 136) and relevant labour and procedural provisions.

53. Implementation of the Palermo Protocol is supported by the National Action Plan on Human Trafficking (2021–2025). The specialized TIP unit of the Suriname Police Force carries out investigation and victim identification in cooperation with the Judiciary and the Labour Inspectorate. Suriname remains classified as Tier 1 in the US Trafficking in Persons Report, in recognition of its compliance with international minimum standards.

54. Victim protection has been strengthened through the Shelter Institutions Act (S.B. 2014 no. 41) and the National Basic Health Insurance Act (S.B. 2014 no. 114, amended by S.B. 2023 no. 124), which safeguard access to shelter and medical and psychosocial care.

55. In 2024–2025, the National Referral Mechanism was further strengthened for the identification, referral and protection of victims of human trafficking, including capacity-building for law-enforcement agencies and front-line officials.

56. In the period 2024–2025, the National Anti-Trafficking Task Force carried out prevention and awareness-raising activities in the border areas of Marowijne, Nickerie and Sipaliwini, aimed at strengthening societal resilience against human trafficking and other forms of exploitation.

# X. Children’s rights and child protection

57. This section reflects the integrated implementation of SDGs 3, 4, 5, 8, 10 and 16, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.79, 97.80, 97.81, 97.82, 97.84, 97.83, 97.86, 97.87, 97.88, 98.35, 98.36, 98.48, 98.50 and 98.51.

58. The protection of the child is anchored in the CRC, the Youth Protection Organization Act (G.B. 1965 no. 110), the Civil Code (Book 1), and the criminal and criminal-procedural provisions of the Criminal Code and the Code of Criminal Procedure. The Children’s Ombudsperson Act (S.B. 2025 no. 1) strengthens institutional oversight of compliance with children’s rights, while further operationalization is underway.

59. To de facto strengthen operational child protection and crisis intervention, the Bureau of Family Law Affairs (BuFaZ) de jure directs the protection of minors in at-risk situations in accordance with the State Decree of 28 December 1983 (S.B. 1983 no. 127). Pursuant to this legal mandate, BuFaZ is competent to initiate preventive child-protection measures and to file petitions with the cantonal court for formal custody arrangements to safeguard the best interests of the child. This institutional mandate, which also includes a structural civil-law advisory function towards the judiciary, intensifies national capacity to de facto protect minors who need special or alternative care within the family structure. In 2024, BuFaZ handled a considerable number of cases of abuse, neglect and sexual abuse.

60. The institutional protection of children’s rights is strengthened by the Children’s Ombudsperson Act (S.B. 2025 no. 1), which provides for the establishment of the Children’s Ombudsman Institute Suriname (KOI). Following the formal promulgation of the Act, the establishment of the KOI entered a concrete operational phase in 2026. In the current 2026 budget year, the Government allocated the financial means for the physical establishment of the head office. The establishment process is currently in the phase of public recruitment and selection of specialized staff, including the Children’s Ombudsperson and the complaints investigators. This guarantees the de facto operationalization and the accessibility of the complaint’s mechanisms for minors in the third quarter of 2026.

61. Pursuant to the Transitional Act on the New Civil Code, the statutory age of majority has been lowered de jure from 21 to 18 years, so that young adults acquire full legal capacity and independent civil-law powers de facto from the age of 18. Furthermore, through this codification the State has absolutely eliminated the historical and discriminatory distinction between legitimate and natural children (born out of wedlock). Every child now enjoys a de jure equal status and identical protection in inheritance and family law, which institutionalizes legal certainty for Surinamese youth in accordance with international human rights standards.

62. The State maintains the de jure elimination of physical and degrading punishment within the education system. Through the Education Innovation Program (OVP), education professionals are systematically trained, in strategic partnership with UNICEF Suriname, in methods of positive discipline as a de facto alternative to corporal punishment. In parallel, institutional child protection is broadened through the National Decentralized Child Protection Program (2024–2026). This program operationalizes the decentralized expansion of local reception and support structures, with priority allocation of capacity to vulnerable communities in the interior, in order to guarantee universal access to legal protection for every minor child.

63. Policy on the health and well-being of children is anchored in the National SRHR Policy 2020–2030, the National Healthcare Renewal Plan and the National Basic Health Insurance Act (S.B. 2014 no. 114, amended by S.B. 2023 no. 124).

64. To prevent child labour, sexual exploitation and abuse, the Youth Information Unit of the Suriname Police Force continuously carries out prevention and awareness programs, in cooperation with relevant ministries and youth structures, including digital campaigns to strengthen societal resilience.

# XI. Persons with disabilities

65. This section reflects the integrated implementation of SDGs 4, 8, 10 and 16, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.87, 97.88 and 97.102.

66. Suriname maintains full de jure compliance with the international CRPD, which the State ratified through the formal approval act in S.B. 2015 no. 48. To harmonized the national legal order with these treaty obligations and to operationalize the principle of non-discrimination in article 8(2) of the Constitution, on 4 June 2024, pursuant to article 78 of the Constitution, the formal member's bill for the General Act for Persons with Disabilities (AWMB) was submitted to the National Assembly. This body of legislation anchors mandatory de jure provisions on universal physical accessibility, the prohibition of employment discrimination, the provision of reasonable accommodation within the education system, and guaranteed social participation within the public and private sectors.

67. The strategic policy is coordinated through the National Policy Plan for Persons with Disabilities Suriname 2025–2030, which was delivered by the Presidential Commission in April 2025 and formally approved through a binding decision of the Council of Government. This central policy document, which is substantively based on the scientific data of the Situation Analysis on Children and Adolescents with Disabilities in Suriname, operationalizes concrete objectives in the areas of inclusive education, targeted labour-market participation and the structural strengthening of inter-ministerial coordination and monitoring mechanisms in accordance with articles 5, 9 and 24 of the CRPD.

68. The material expansion of the national social-protection network has been consolidated through the overarching Financial Assistance for Persons with Disabilities program of the Ministry of SoZaVo. According to the verified statistical data of the Suriname Planning Bureau Foundation (SPS), the reach of these direct financial benefits has been systematically scaled up from 10,940 registered clients in 2021 to 21,982 clients in 2024, and grown further to a current number of 23,633 active beneficiaries in June 2025.

69. The State recognizes that, although social budgets have been substantially increased, this vulnerable target group still faces infrastructural, geographical and cultural barriers in daily practice in accessing regular health care and public transport.

# XII. Education

70. This section reflects the integrated implementation of SDGs 3, 4, 5, 10 and 16, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.43, 97.86, 97.87, 97.88, 98.35, 98.36, 98.37, 98.38, 98.39 and 98.40.

71. To give de jure and de facto effect to the right to universal quality education (SDG 4), the Ministry of Education, Science and Culture is implementing far-reaching structural reforms. This policy framework is strategically anchored in the National Education Policy Plan Suriname 2024–2031 (NOBS), aimed at quality improvement, digitalization and eliminating regional asymmetry for the benefit of vulnerable groups in the interior.

72. Within this transformative framework, the State has proceeded to the de facto introduction of Development-Oriented Education (OGO) and the integration of Comprehensive Sexuality Education (CSE) into the national curriculum. This is flanked by the National Multisectoral Early Childhood Development Policy 2025–2035 to prevent early learning delays. Although programmatically consolidated, operationalization is in the implementation phase, pending de jure anchoring in an updated Primary Education Act, while work is also underway on an integrated system for the annual public monitoring of learning outcomes and school dropout.

73. The de facto implementation of the CSE curriculum is cross-sectoral synchronized with the National Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) Policy 2020–2030 to reduce teenage pregnancies and promote gender equality. This preventive strategy is operationally supported by the structural deployment of the Youth Information Unit of the Suriname Police Force (KPS) through targeted school and media interventions (2024–2026), as well as by the University Institute for Children's Rights of the AdeKUS. The State recognizes that the systematic impact measurement and coverage of these programs per school location require further data-technical strengthening.

74. To protect the cultural and linguistic treaty rights of Indigenous and tribal peoples, the Multilingual Education Program 2025–2030 was formally ratified in October 2024. This framework operationalizes education in local languages, deployed de facto through successful pilot projects such as the bilingual education project in Galibi. However, nationwide scaling-up to other parts of the interior encounters infrastructural, logistical and staffing barriers, which the Government aims to mitigate through targeted capacity expansion.

75. To structurally reduce the de facto school dropout in the interior, which averages 21 per cent, the State is implementing a coherent package of social and infrastructural measures in the period 2024–2028. This includes the National School Feeding and Health Program, the School Packages Project, subsidized pupil transport by bus and boat, and the National Protocol on Inclusive Education 2025.

76. De jure, geographical inequality is broken down through the decentralization of education services via strategic core center's in Atjoni, Apoera and Stoelmanseiland, flanked by digital access through satellite connections (VSAT) under the National E-Education Strategy Plan. This is strengthened by measures against the teacher shortage in rural areas through station allowances, the renovation of service housing and the expansion of physical school facilities in, among other places, Sipaliwini, Amatopo and Coeroeni.

# XIII. Health

77. This section reflects the integrated implementation of SDGs 3, 4, 5, 10 and 16, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.22, 97.23, 97.39, 97.41, 97.44, 97.45, 97.46, 97.47, 97.48, 97.49, 97.50, 97.51, 98.35, 98.36, 98.37, 98.38, 98.39, 99.8, 99.9, 99.10 and 99.11.

78. To give de jure and de facto effect to the right to health (art. 36 Constitution, SDG 3), the National Basic Health Insurance Act (S.B. 2014 no. 114, amended in 2023) guarantees universal access to care. This framework is operationally anchored in the National Healthcare Renewal Plan (2021–2025) to modernize the system. The care infrastructure has a dual primary-care structure through the Regional Health Service for the coastal plain (managing more than 50 clinics) and the Medical Mission for the interior, which provides primary care through more than 50 clinics to approximately 54,000 inhabitants in Brokopondo and Sipaliwini. This network is flanked at the tertiary level by the Academic Hospital Paramaribo, the Wanica Hospital, the Mungra Medical Centre (Nickerie) and the hospital in Albina, with

acute care in rural areas relying on local stabilization and medical evacuation by boat or air transport due to geographical and socio-economic barriers.

79. To de facto strengthen acute and tertiary care, on 25 June 2026 the State launched the large-scale Healthcare Facilities Readiness Initiative, supported by an allocated budget of more than SRD 635 million for the infrastructural expansion of the AZP. This capital injection finances four vital sub-projects: the renovation of the Thorax and Cardio Coronary Care Unit, the second phase of the western wing (Radiology and Laboratories), the modernization of the laboratories for Clinical Chemistry and Microbiology, and the expansion of the Emergency Department (SEH). To mitigate staffing shortages and stem the brain drain, the Ministry is preparing a supplementary budget allocation of SRD 3.2 billion to revise the salary scales for health-care staff and better equip regional posts.

80. In the fight against infectious diseases, Suriname reached a historic public-health milestone; in 2025 the country was officially certified malaria-free by the World Health Organization, following an uninterrupted zero-measurement of local transmission in the period 2021–2024. At the same time, the Bureau of Public Health operationalizes integrated prevention programs, vector control and source removal to control other mosquito-borne diseases, including dengue and chikungunya.

81. To manage ecological health determinants in the interior, universal access to safe drinking water and sanitation (SDG 6) remains a priority challenge. Within the framework of the UN WASH program, targeted interventions were carried out in 2022 in 57 villages along the Tapanahoni and Upper Suriname rivers, comprising the installation of 118 rainwater tanks to mitigate the risk of diarrhea and skin infections. Evaluations show that the de facto sustainability of these systems requires intensive monitoring, as currently one of the thirteen larger water systems is fully functional with water treatment.

82. Maternal and child care has been decentralized and digitized in accordance with article 12 ICESCR and article 24 CRC. The introduction and nationwide scaling-up of the SIP Plus perinatal information system in 2024 and 2025 has led to sharpened registration and quality control in hospitals and centers. This is programmatically supplemented by the National SRHR Policy 2020–2030, which, in cooperation with UNFPA, PAHO/WHO and the Youth Information Unit of the KPS, intensifies access to contraception and integrates Comprehensive Sexuality Education (CSE) into the education curriculum to reduce teenage pregnancies.

83. Supported by partnerships with PAHO/WHO, UNICEF, the Global Fund, the IDB, and Cuban medical professionals, mental health care has been integrated into primary care through the National Mental Health and Suicide Prevention Strategies 2025–2030, which included extensive 2025 mhGAP training, rural hygiene programs, children's-rights education, and free psychosocial support via Helplines 114 and 123.

# XIV. Social protection, poverty reduction and labour

84. This section reflects the integrated implementation of SDGs 1, 3, 5, 8, 10 and 16, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.22, 97.39, 97.40, 97.41, 97.43, 98.35 and 98.36. The national normative framework is implemented in strict accordance with the obligations under the ICESCR and the CRC.

85. The right to social security and an adequate standard of living is anchored in articles 36 and 37 of the Constitution and is implemented through the National Social Protection Strategy (NSPS) 2024–2030. This framework, in line with ILO Convention 102, strengthens social protection across the life cycle, with a focus on expanding social assistance, improved targeting and better access for vulnerable groups in rural and interior areas.

86. Social transfers are carried out through the Moni Karta system of the Ministry of SoZaVo. In 2024, cash transfers reached 133,560 beneficiaries; in 2025, financial assistance for vulnerable households amounted to 20,326 clients. The General Old-Age Provision covers approximately 77,246 older persons (more than 98%), while the General Child Allowance supports approximately 96,500 children and contributes to the implementation of the CRC on the subsistence security of families.

87. Economic recovery and stabilization have strengthened social programs, although inflation and rising costs of living remain structural challenges. In this context, measures are being implemented under the Minimum Wage Act (S.B. 2019 no. 57) and the Social Security Modernization Project (2025–2026), including the development of an integrated social register. The legal position of citizens and families has been further strengthened by the new Civil Code (S.B. 2024 no. 164), in force since 1 May 2025.

88. The Decent Work Country Program (DWCP) 2023–2026 promotes employment, training and labour-market participation of young people, women and vulnerable groups, including Indigenous and tribal communities. The social-security base has been strengthened by the growth of the Pension Fund Suriname from 28,224 participants (2021) to 32,213 (2024), alongside preparations for the General Pension Act and the draft Local Content Act to strengthen national labour participation.

89. Structural inequalities persist between urban areas and the interior due to geographical distance, limited infrastructure and low digital and financial inclusion. A large part of the working population is active in the informal sector, so that social protection and labour rights are not universal, particularly for young people and low-skilled workers.

90. The development of the oil and gas sector offers economic opportunities but also challenges for social protection and equality. Future revenues must contribute to strengthening social programs, public services and poverty reduction, within a robust governance framework that safeguards inclusive growth and protects the rights under the ICESCR.

91. Furthermore, legislative measures are under consideration, including the implementation of ILO Convention No. 190, ILO Recommendations Nos. 204, 205 and 206, the Financial Inclusion Act and the draft Local Content Act, aimed at strengthening decent work, inclusive economic participation and the expansion of social protection.

# XV. Indigenous and tribal communities

92. This section reflects the integrated implementation of SDGs 3, 4, 6, 10, 13, 15 and 16, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.24, 97.36, 97.61–97.63, 97.65–97.78, 97.85, 97.86, 97.87, 97.94, 98.1–98.21 and 98.23–98.24.

93. Suriname reaffirms its international and regional obligations toward Indigenous and tribal peoples under the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP, 2007) and the jurisprudence of the Inter-American Court of Human Rights, specifically the cases Moiwana Community v. Suriname (2005) and Saamaka People v. Suriname (2007). These legal frameworks oblige the State to provide effective protection of collective property rights, consultation, and legal redress.

94. Within this framework, the draft Act on the Collective Rights of Indigenous and Tribal Peoples (initiated in 2019, with renewed parliamentary treatment in 2023–2025) has been further elaborated. Consultations within the National Assembly with traditional authorities – including the Kali'ña, Lokono, and Maroon communities – led to amendments focusing on legal recognition, territorial demarcation, and enhanced legal certainty.

95. To operationalize Free, Prior and Informed Consent, the Association of Indigenous Village Leaders in Suriname (VIDS) formally handed over the national FPIC protocol to the Government on 14 October 2025. Serving as a national framework for decision-making regarding economic, industrial, and infrastructural activities in traditional territories, an inter-ministerial commission is currently studying modalities to integrate this protocol as a formal guideline for consultations in the interior.

96. Pending a definitive statutory regulation of collective land rights, the Act on the Protection of the Residential and Living Areas of Indigenous and Tribal Peoples has been approved by the National Assembly. As of July 2026, the Government is consulting with the Traditional Authority to incorporate their insights and potential adjustments before its official promulgation.

97. While Article 1a of the New Civil Code recognizes de jure customary law, its validity is constitutionally bounded by the national legal order and the Criminal Code. Consequently, local customs can never override national legislation protecting minors and universal human rights standards, ensuring uniform legal protection against child marriage and early sexualization throughout Surinamese territory.

98. Access to basic healthcare in the interior is delivered via a layered network consisting of the Medical Mission , the Regional Health Service, and the Bureau of Public Health. The Medical Mission, institutionally strengthened in the 2000s and further expanded during 2018–2025, serves as the primary care provider in remote areas through its network of clinics in traditional villages, while RGD clinics in coastal and transitional areas function as regional links for medical referrals.

99. Within this healthcare system, BOG manages public-health interventions such as vaccination campaigns, epidemiological surveillance, and infection prevention. Emergency and maternal care rely on a medical evacuation system via river, air, or regional transport to hospitals in Paramaribo, including the Academic Hospital Paramaribo, which was structurally strengthened during 2020–2026. However, care coverage remains challenged by geographical distance, staffing constraints, and transport capacity.

100. Addressing environmental health, BOG and MZ implement integrated hygiene and sanitation programs, with specific focus on the public health impact of small-scale gold mining and mercury pollution. This mitigation aligns with international frameworks, including the Pan American Health Organization and the Minamata Convention on Mercury (2013, in force 2017).

101. Between 2022 and 2024, the UN WASH program supported the phased expansion of water and sanitation infrastructure, installing rainwater storage systems and drinking-water infrastructure in over 50 villages across the Tapanahoni, Langu, and Upper Suriname river areas. Despite these interventions, parts of the interior remain dependent on traditional water sources, posing ongoing challenges for water quality.

102. To reduce structural inequalities, the Multilingual Education Program (2025–2030), approved in 2024, launched pilot projects in Indigenous areas like Galibi to provide education in local languages, satisfying cultural and linguistic rights under UNDRIP (2007). This policy is further supported by the National Education Policy Plan Suriname 2024–2031.

103. The National Social Protection Strategy (NSPS 2024–2030) expands social services to the interior, including cash transfers, child allowance, and elderly care, facilitated by the digital Moni Karta system of the Ministry of Social Affairs and Housing.

104. Acknowledging that logistical constraints continue to affect full access to basic services, the State invested in rural energy, transport links, and digital infrastructure between 2023 and 2026. This includes expanding satellite communication (VSAT) and local facilities in remote villages to structurally narrow the urban-rural gap.

# XVI. Climate, environment, drinking water and sustainable development

105. This chapter reflects the integrated de jure and de facto implementation of SDGs 3, 6, 7, 10, 13, 15 and 17, in conjunction with the specific UPR recommendations 97.21, 97.22, 97.24, 97.42, 97.86, 97.88, 97.90, 97.102, 97.106 and 98.28–98.29.

106. Suriname implements its obligations under the UNFCCC and the Paris Agreement to maintain its universal carbon-negative status (forest cover of 93%). The environmental-law foundation is anchored in the Environmental Framework Act (S.B. 2020 no. 97, amended by S.B. 2024 no. 56), which provides the formal framework for environmental management and the national permit system. In line with the ambitions of this Act, the State is studying the preconditions for possible future accession to the Regional Agreement on Access to Information, Participation and Justice in Environmental Matters (Escazú Agreement).

107. The National Environmental Authority (NMA) directs independent oversight and enforcement. Since the operationalization of the applicable EIA/ESIA decision, large-scale

industrial projects are mandatorily subject to Environmental Impact Assessments (EIA) in accordance with ESG standards. In the context of the imminent de facto exploitation of offshore oil and gas reserves, including the GranMorgu project in Block 58 from 2028, the State maintains strict environmental-law preconditions. The NMA ensures, as a matter of mandatory law, that all exploration and production phases are preceded by cross-border EIAs and Oil Spill Emergency Plans, for the de jure protection of marine ecosystems. This is flanked by the Sustainable Nature Management Act to protect the High Forest, Low Deforestation (HFLD) status.

108. Climate and adaptation policy is anchored in the National Adaptation Plan (NAP 2020–2030) and the updated Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs 2021/2025), which recognize the direct impact of climate change on fundamental human rights (food security, housing and health). Given that more than 80% of the population resides in the low-lying coastal plain, the State is highly vulnerable to sea-level rise and flooding. In parallel, Suriname implements the Minamata Convention on Mercury through the NAP-ASGM (2021–2025) and the EMSAGS program to reduce mercury use in small-scale gold mining. In this context, the NMA carries out de facto monitoring of soil and water pollution in the interior, in synergy with public-health interventions of the Bureau of Public Health (BOG), to prevent mercury poisoning within rural living areas.

109. To give de facto effect to the right to clean drinking water and sustainable energy in rural areas, in particular to implement the specific UPR recommendations on basic services in the interior, the Ministry of Natural Resources (NH), through the Water Supply Service (DWV) and the Electrification Supply Service (DEV), directs targeted infrastructural programs. Given that currently less than 40% of the population in the interior has structural access to safe drinking water, the State applies the model of Integrated Water Resources Management (IWRM). Within this framework and to achieve SDG 6, the installation of automated surface-water treatment systems and 118 rainwater tanks in 57 villages has been realized through the UN WASH programs. To consolidate this progressive realization, a large-scale drinking-water project for 26 rural communities (including the Langu area and the planned capacity expansion in Galibi) is currently in the preparation and implementation phase, gradually mitigating the historical backlog in de facto access to safe drinking water.

110. Flanked by traditional community consultations (krutus) and the pending Spatial Planning, Pesticides Management, and Local Content HSEQ Acts, the Suriname Villages Micro-grid Solar Project has secured 24-hour power for 38 villages across the Djoemoe, Poeketie, and Manlobi clusters, commissioned new solar plants in Goejaba, Galibi, and the Langu area (1,300 households), and is actively expanding to 25 more villages in the Gran Rio and Pikin Rio areas.

# XVII. Challenges and remaining points of attention

111. Institutional capacity, legislative reforms and press freedom: Fragmentation of government and a lack of fine-grained data delay de facto human rights monitoring. Although the State is willing to undertake direct legislative harmonization, the final adoption of the draft acts for the National Human Rights Institute and the Public Health Framework Act is hindered by a shortage of specialized legislative-drafting capacity in the pre-parliamentary phase, while the Act on the Collective Rights of Indigenous and Tribal Peoples requires intensive deliberation to safeguard broad national consensus following the formal amendment. Although press freedom is constitutionally anchored, the decline on the international index (from 28 to 32) requires de jure modernization of the Criminal Code with respect to defamation provisions. The State prioritizes the accelerated realization of the Freedom of Information Act to protect journalists against self-censorship and to harmonized with the ICCPR.

112. Access to basic services, migration and protection of vulnerable groups: Ensuring equal and barrier-free de facto access to tertiary health care, quality education and social security remains under heavy infrastructural and geographical pressure, in particular for Indigenous and tribal communities in rural areas. This rule-of-law risk is substantially increased by the persistent brain drain and exodus of specialized medical and teaching

personnel abroad. In parallel, the effective enforcement against gender-based violence, human trafficking and discrimination of marginalized groups, including the LGBTQ+ community, requires centralized reception structures and renewed judicial priority. Climate vulnerability, environmental protection and economic transition: as a low-lying coastal State with a unique High Forest, Low Deforestation (HFLD) status, Suriname is extremely vulnerable to the de facto destructive effects of climate change, including sea-level rise and acute flooding risks. This ecological vulnerability intersects directly with public health and the integrity of traditional living areas through the persistent environmental impact of illegal, small-scale gold mining and the associated mercury pollution. The enforcement capacity of the NMA encounters logistical barriers in the interior.

113. Financial constraints and international cooperation: Suriname's status as a Small Island Developing State (SIDS) entails inherent budgetary constraints and shortages of specialized technical expertise. The de facto realization of the SDGs and the full implementation of the UPR recommendations therefore remain directly dependent on strategic international partnerships, de facto technical assistance and targeted multilateral financing mechanisms to maximize national implementation capacity.

# XVIII. Closing statement

114. The Republic of Suriname reaffirms its unconditional sovereign commitment to the promotion and de facto protection of all human rights and fundamental freedoms, in strict accordance with the Constitution, the international treaty system and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. The State maintains its constructive participation within the UPR mechanism as an essential platform for dialogue, capacity-strengthening and mutual cooperation. To give effect to the remaining recommendations and priorities, the Government is intensifying its legislative harmonization and de jure institutional capacity-building. Suriname expresses its explicit appreciation for the technical assistance and support of both national and international partners, and commits itself fully to continuing these strategic partnerships towards the realization of an inclusive and just rule of law for society as a whole.